

Solar Power Conversion Solution:

Maximizes Solar Panel Output

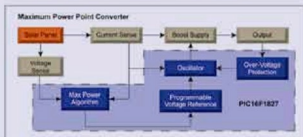


Engineers' projects are relying on renewable energy sources to help meet the need for remote operation of electronic devices. As the use of remote electronic devices increases, power for these devices becomes more of a concern. Remote applications are powered mostly by batteries that are either recharged or changed on a regular basis.

Microchip's application note (AN1211) shows how to get the maximum power out of a solar panel to power a remote application. The Maximum Power Point Converter is a DC-to-DC converter, where the DC input voltage is the solar panel and the output voltage is a DC voltage that can either run the application or recharge a battery.

The Max Power Point Converter continually measures and adjusts the power out of the solar panel in order to operate the panel at its maximum power point, independent of the panel's illumination or temperature.

As solar panels increase in efficiency, more applications will begin to use them as either a primary power source or as a backup power source. For applications where the ambient light is continually changing, the Maximum Power Solar Converter can be a very effective tool in increasing the total power delivered by the solar panel.



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